

[Lesson 43](#): “Take upon You My Whole Armor” (See L43 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us put on the full armor of God to protect us in the battle against evil.

[Pictures of our Church Presidents](#)

1. Put on the whole armor of God.

- [D&C 76:25-30](#) and [Moses 4:3](#). We “saw a vision of the sufferings of those with whom he made war and overcame”.
- [D&C 27:15-18](#). “Wherefore, ... take upon you my whole armor, that ye may be able to withstand the evil day”.

What is the Lord’s armor described in these verses?

†1. The Lord’s Armor

What can we do to put on the “whole armor” of God?

How have you felt added protection from temptation as you have prayed? Studied the scriptures? Kept the Sabbath day holy? Gone to the temple? Honored the priesthood?

What might be the consequences of wearing only part of the Lord’s armor or wearing it just part of the time?

†2. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin †3. Elder Bernard P. Brockbank †4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie (Add D&C 97:8 “willing”)

The following are three important areas “in which Satan is trying to exploit weaknesses in our armor today: chastity, honesty, and language.” (*Lesson Manual*)

2. Live the law of chastity.

- [D&C 42:22–24](#) and [63:16](#). “Thou shalt love thy wife with all thy heart, and shalt cleave unto her and none else.”

- Read *For the Strength of Youth*: [Sexual Purity](#)

†5. The First Presidency

†6. Elder Richard G. Scott

†7. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin

What are some consequences of violating the law of chastity?

- [D&C 121:45–46](#). How are we blessed as we live the law of chastity?

How does Satan tempt people to violate the law of chastity?

- Read *For the Strength of Youth*: [Dress and Appearance](#); [Entertainment and the Media](#);

- Read [Music and Dancing](#) and click on the link “The Influence of Music” and read about mice, music, and learning.)

†8. President Gordon B. Hinckley †9. Elder Neal A. Maxwell †10. President Spencer W. Kimball

How can we protect ourselves from temptations to violate the law of chastity? †11. Elder Boyd K. Packer

What can we do in our homes to avoid immoral influences? How can we follow Elder Packer’s counsel?

3. Be honest.

What does it mean to be honest? †12. President James E. Faust

- Read *For the Strength of Youth*: [Honesty and Integrity](#)

- [D&C 42:21](#), [51:9](#), and [97:8](#). All “among them who know their hearts are honest, and are broken, ...”.

Why is it important to be honest in all aspects of our lives? What are the consequences of being dishonest?

How are we blessed as we are honest? What does it mean to be honest with ourselves and with the Lord?

How can we effectively teach honesty in our homes?

4. Use language that reverences God and is edifying.

- [D&C 63:60–62](#) and [136:21](#). “Keep yourselves from evil to take the name of the Lord in vain”.

What are some ways that people take the Lord’s name in vain?

What other kinds of language should we avoid?

†13. President Gordon B. Hinckley

- Read *For the Strength of Youth*: [Language](#)

Why is learning to control our words essential to our spiritual growth?

What are some consequences of using bad language? †14. Elder Dallin H. Oaks

How does Satan tempt people to use profane, vulgar, or obscene language?

How can we overcome temptations to use bad language?

- [D&C 52:16](#); [136:24](#); [Ephesians 4:29](#). In what ways can our words edify others?

How can parents teach children not to use bad language?

How can we encourage others to use language that reverences God and is edifying?

†15. Elder Boyd K. Packer

†16. Ted L. Gibbons

Next Week: L44: Being Good Citizens; See L44 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).) † •

†1. The Lord's Armor:

1. Loins girt about with truth
2. Breastplate of righteousness
3. Feet shod with preparation of gospel of peace
4. Shield of faith
5. Helmet of salvation
6. Sword of God's Spirit and His word

†2. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin warned that Satan “seeks to find any chink in the armor of each person. He knows our weaknesses and knows how to exploit them if we allow him to do so. We can defend ourselves against his attacks and deceptions only by understanding the commandments and by fortifying ourselves each day through praying, studying the scriptures, and following the counsel of the Lord’s anointed” (“[The Priesthood of God](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1988, 35).

†3. Elder Bernard P. Brockbank: “The whole armor of God will keep the divine light of Jesus Christ inside and the darkness of evil outside. All who wear the full armor of God will be filled with pure love, happiness, peace, and godlike self-respect.” (“[God’s Way to Eternal Life](#),” *Ensign*, Jan. 1974 from his Oct. 1973 General Conference talk.)

†4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie: “Paul then warned the Ephesians ... that we can only withstand the evils which surround us by putting on the *whole* armor of God ... which means keeping *all* the commandments of God” (“[Put on the Whole Armor of God](#),” *Ensign*, May 1979).

†5. The First Presidency: “The Lord’s law of moral conduct is abstinence outside of lawful marriage and fidelity within marriage. Sexual relations are proper only between husband and wife appropriately expressed within the bonds of marriage. Any other sexual contact, including fornication, adultery, and homosexual and lesbian behavior, is sinful” (First Presidency letter, 14 Nov. 1991).

†6. Elder Richard G. Scott: “Any sexual intimacy outside of the bonds of marriage—I mean any intentional contact with the sacred, private parts of another’s body, with or without clothing—is a sin and is forbidden by God. It is also a transgression to intentionally stimulate these emotions within your own body” (“[Making the Right Choices](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1994, 38).

†7. Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin: “One of the most pervasive deceptions in recent years is the notion that immorality is normal and acceptable and has no negative consequences. In truth, immorality is the underlying cause of much suffering and many other

problems that are prevalent today, including rampant disease, abortion, broken families, families without fathers, and mothers who themselves are children” (“[Deep Roots](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1994, 76).

†8. President Gordon B. Hinckley: “You must not fool around with the Internet to find pornographic material. You must not dial a long-distance telephone number to listen to filth. You must not rent videos with [pornography](#) of any kind. This salacious stuff simply is not for you. Stay away from pornography as you would avoid a serious disease. It is destructive. It can become habitual, and those who indulge in it get so they cannot leave it alone. It is addictive” (“[Living Worthy of the Girl You Will Someday Marry](#),” *Ensign*, May 1998, 49).

†9. Elder Neal A. Maxwell: “We are lathered in soap operas in need of nothing so much as soap—for the scrubbing of themselves. Some seriously maintain that media violence and sleaze leave consumers untouched. But revenue is received from commercials precisely because of their influence. Either we deserve reforms, or sponsors deserve refunds!” (“[Behold, the Enemy Is Combined](#),” *Ensign*, May 1993.)

†10. President Spencer W. Kimball: “Pornography and erotic stories and pictures are worse than polluted food. Shun them. The body has power to rid itself of sickening food. That person who entertains filthy stories or pornographic pictures and literature records them in his marvelous human computer, the brain, which can’t forget this filth. Once recorded, it will always remain there, subject to recall—filthy images.” (*Teachings of Spencer W. Kimball*, 283)

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Boyd K. Packer, “[The Clean Voice of Youth](#),” *New Era*, Jan. 1976.
2. Nancy Jensen at LDS Gospel Doctrine Plus, [Lesson #43](#).
3. Rosemary M. Wixom, “[The Influence of Music](#),” Youth Articles at lds.org. Music influences nervous systems of mice.
4. Elder Bruce R. McConkie, “[Put on the Whole Armor of God](#),” *Ensign*, May 1979.

Recommended Media:

1. Video: [We Believe in Being Chaste](#) (1:17)
2. Video: [Worthy to Be a Voice for God](#) (5:10)
3. Video: [Watch Your Step](#) (2:39)

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†11. Elder Boyd K. Packer: “Years ago I put up some signs in my mind. They are very clearly printed and simply read: “No trespassing.” “No dumping allowed.” On occasions it has been necessary to show them very plainly to others.

“I do not want anything coming into my mind that does not have some useful purpose or some value that makes it worth keeping. I have enough trouble keeping the weeds down that sprout there on their own without permitting someone else to clutter my mind with things that do not edify.

“I’ve hauled a few of these away in my lifetime. Occasionally I’ve tossed these thoughts back over the fence where they came from, when it could be done in a friendly manner.

“I’ve had to evict some thoughts a hundred times before they would stay out. I have never been successful until I have put something edifying in their place.

“I do not want my mind to be a dumping place for shabby ideas or thoughts, for disappointments, bitterness, envy, shame, hatred, worry, grief, or jealousy.” (“[The Balm of Gilead](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1977, 60)

†12. President James E. Faust: “Honesty is more than not lying. It is truth telling, truth speaking, truth living, and truth loving” (“[Honesty—a Moral Compass](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1996, 41).

†13. President Gordon B. Hinckley: “Don’t swear. Don’t profane. Avoid so-called dirty jokes. Stay away from conversation that is sprinkled with foul and filthy words. You will be happier if you do so, and your example will give strength to others” (“[Take Not the Name of God in Vain](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1987, 48).

†14. Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “Profanity and vulgarity ... are sins that separate us from God and cripple our spiritual defenses by causing the Holy Ghost to withdraw from us” (“[Reverent and Clean](#),” *Ensign*, May 1986, 52).

†15. Elder Boyd K. Packer: “A number of years ago I went with a brother to tow in a wrecked car. It had been a single car accident, and the car was demolished; the driver, though unhurt, had been taken to the hospital for treatment of shock and for examination.

“The next morning he came asking for his car, anxious to be on his way. When he was shown the wreckage, his pent-up emotions and disappointment, sharpened perhaps by his misfortune, exploded in a long stream of profanity. So obscene and biting were

his words that they exposed years of practice with profanity. His words were heard by other customers, among them women, and must have touched their ears like acid.

“One of my brothers crawled from beneath the car where he had been working with a large wrench. He too was upset, and with threatening gestures of the wrench (mechanics will know that a 16-inch crescent wrench is a formidable weapon), he ordered him off the premises. ‘We don’t have to listen to that kind of language here,’ he said. And the customer left, cursing more obscenely than before.

“Much later in the day he reappeared. Subdued, penitent, and avoiding everyone else, he found my brother.

“ ‘I have been in the hotel room all day,’ he said, ‘lying on the bed, tormented. I can’t tell you how utterly ashamed I am for what happened this morning. My conduct was inexcusable. I have been trying to think of some justification, and I can think of only one thing: In all my life, never, not once, have I been told that my language was not acceptable. I have always talked that way. You were the first one who ever told me that my language was out of order.’

“Isn’t it interesting that a man could grow to maturity, the victim of such a vile habit, and never meet a protest? How tolerant we have become!” (“[The Clean Voice of Youth](#),” *New Era*, Jan. 1976)

†16. Ted L. Gibbons: “Many years ago I was *invited* by Uncle Sam to experience the U. S. Army. During some initial training in Georgia I listened to an almost unceasing barrage of filthy jokes. The jokes came mostly from instructors at the beginning of lessons. On one occasion I sat in a grassy area with 23 other young men waiting for instruction in the use of the bayonet. As the sergeant began to speak he launched into what I knew would be another filthy story. A former missionary companion was seated next to me. We were the only Latter-day Saints in the group. I glanced at him and he at me, and then we dropped our heads and tried to take our minds somewhere else. The lecture stopped for a moment, and then the instructor, who must have seen our action and interpreted it correctly, asked, “Does anyone mind if I tell this story?”

“I glanced at my friend who nodded at me. We kept our heads down but raised our hands. The silence returned and continued until it was obvious that something had happened. We raised our eyes and found that almost every hand in the platoon was up.” (“[Take Upon You My Whole Armor](#),” D&C Lesson 43)

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